Name: _____ Date: Fri 11/6

Spaghetti Bake and Mug Birthday Cake (Level 3)

Spaghetti Bake — yield: one 8x8 pan, 6–7 servings

Ingredients: 12 oz dry spaghetti · 8 oz lean ground beef (optional) · 1 jar (24 oz) marinara · 1 ½ cups shredded mozzarella · ¼ cup grated parmesan · nonstick spray

Method 1. Preheat the oven to 375°F. Spray an 8x8 baking dish. 2. Bring 4 quarts of water to a boil. Add the spaghetti, broken in half. Cook 9 minutes (1–2 minutes less than the box says, because it keeps cooking in the oven). Drain. 3. Meanwhile, brown the beef in a skillet over medium heat, 6–8 minutes, until no pink remains (160°F). Drain the fat. Stir in the sauce and heat through. 4. Combine pasta and sauce. Spread in the dish. Top with mozzarella, then parmesan. 5. Cover with foil and bake 15 minutes. Uncover and bake 5 more minutes, until the cheese bubbles. 6. Rest 5 minutes before cutting.

Mug Birthday Cake — yield: 1 serving (boxed mix)

Ingredients: 4 Tbsp boxed cake mix · 2 Tbsp water · sprinkles or frosting (optional). If the box has its own mug directions, follow the box.

Why no egg? The box asks for eggs and oil to make a full cake. A single mug cake works with just mix and water.

Method: Put the mix in a 12-oz+ microwave-safe mug. Add water and stir until no dry mix remains. Microwave on high 60 seconds; if the top is still wet, add 15-second rounds, up to 90 seconds total (1000-watt microwave; lower-watt ovens may need 15–30 seconds more). The mug and center get very hot: use a mitt and rest 2 minutes. Overcooking makes it dry and tough.

Measuring and fractions practice

1. 4 Tbsp = ____ cup. (Hint: 16 Tbsp = 1 cup.)
2. 2 Tbsp water = ____ cup.
3. The bake uses 12 oz of a 16-oz box. What fraction of the box is that? ____ What is left over? ____ oz
4. You make 2 mug cakes. How much mix? ____ Tbsp. How much water? ____ Tbsp

Scaling question

The class has 13 people. Each pan feeds 6–7. - How many pans do we need? ____ - How much spaghetti in total? ____ oz. Is one 1-lb box enough? ____ Why? _____ - 13 mug cakes × 4 Tbsp mix = ____ Tbsp = ____ cups. One box of mix holds about 3 ½ cups. Is one box enough? ____

Reflection

What step took the longest? How would you plan your time to make this at home on a weeknight?